

ALEX CHEN

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TARGET ROLE

Google Software Engineer Intern, US

RESUME STRATEGY

- Route: Big Tech software engineering, ATS-friendly one-page resume.
- Section order: Education, Technical Skills, Experience, Projects.
- Emphasis: software development, data structures, production-minded reliability, cross-functional work, and scalable product thinking.

EDUCATION

COLUMBIA UNIVERSITY

M.S. in Computer Science, expected May 2027

- Relevant coursework: distributed systems, machine learning, databases, algorithms.

UNIVERSITY OF ILLINOIS URBANA-CHAMPAIGN

B.S. in Statistics and Computer Science, May 2025

- GPA: 3.8/4.0.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- Languages: Python, JavaScript, TypeScript, SQL, Java.
- Frameworks and tools: React, Node.js, PostgreSQL, Git, Docker, pandas.
- Foundations: algorithms, databases, machine learning, data validation.

EXPERIENCE

DATA PLATFORM INTERN, FINSIGHT ANALYTICS

June 2025 - August 2025

- Built Python data validation scripts for financial transaction datasets, improving reliability of downstream analytics workflows.
- Investigated broken ETL checks and documented recurring data quality issues for two data engineers and one product manager.
- Contributed to dashboard reliability improvements by tracing data refresh failures and proposing validation checkpoints. [Need detail: error-rate reduction or dashboard refresh improvement]

SOFTWARE ENGINEERING PROJECT, CAMPUS COURSE PLANNER

January 2025 - May 2025

- Developed a React and Node.js web application that helps students compare course schedules and save academic plans.
- Designed PostgreSQL schemas for courses, prerequisites, and saved plans, supporting structured search and filtering.
- Implemented filters for department, time, professor, and requirement type to improve course discovery. [Need detail: number of users, courses, or test cases]

PROJECTS

RECOMMENDATION SYSTEM PROTOTYPE

- Trained a Python collaborative filtering model and evaluated ranking quality with precision, recall, and mean average precision.
- Connected model evaluation to product relevance by comparing recommended items against known user preferences. [Need detail: dataset size and best metric values]

OPTIMIZATION REPORT

STRONGEST MATCHES

- Python, JavaScript, SQL, React, Node.js, and PostgreSQL align with Google's general-purpose coding and web application requirements.
- ETL validation and dashboard reliability work show software quality, debugging, and product reliability evidence.
- Course planner project shows full-stack implementation, database design, and user-facing product thinking.

EVIDENCE GAPS

- Add quantified impact for dashboard reliability, such as refresh success rate, number of checks, or failures reduced.
- Add scale for the course planner, such as number of courses, users, records, or tests.
- Add more explicit algorithm/data structure evidence from coursework or projects.